



# SMBA Draft RFP Industry Day – Recent Updates

*March 18, 2026*



- Purpose: Provide an overview of SMBA contract, evaluation criteria, PRD changes, and other recent Draft RFP updates
  - Note: The final RFP is the next major drop. While there may be additional Industry Days and some smaller updates, no additional full dRFP update is planned.
    - No longer making changes, will provide clarifications
- Posted:
  - Amendment 23: Mission Suitability Section L and M Update
    - Amnt 23 - MS Sections L and M.pdf
  - Amendment 24: Performance Requirements Document, Revision E
    - Amnt 24 – SMBA PRD Rev E.pdf
  - Amendment 25: Questions and Answers related to Performance Requirements Document
    - Amnt 25 – Technical QA for PRD Rev E.pdf
  - Other RFP Updates

- Ground Rules
- SMBA RFP Areas to Highlight
- SMBA RFP Areas to Note
- PRD Changes Overview
- Timeline
- Questions

- The NEON Series-1 team will continue to conduct one on ones with Industry Partners as requested until Black Out
  - No longer making document updates
  - NEON Series-1 team will continue to clarify current documents until Black Out
- Salient information will be provided to all Industry Partners
  - Questions will be posted anonymously
- The final chart deck from today is posted on SAM.gov
- The Final Request for Proposal and its terms and conditions will supersede any statements in this document

- CLIN Structure
- Option Removal
- Delivery and Launch Dates
- Funding Profile
- Mission Suitability Volume Proposal Instructions

- CLIN 0001: Cost Plus Fixed Fee with Schedule Incentive for Flight Model (FM) 1
  - Non-Recurring Engineering, Engineering Development Program, FM1 Production through Launch + 6 Months, FM 1-3 Parts
- CLIN 0002: Firm Fixed Price FM2 and FM3
  - Production through Bench Acceptance Test at the Spacecraft Vendor Facility
- CLIN 0003: Time and Material
  - Task Orders for: Special Studies, Post-Commissioning Support (FM1), Post-Bench Acceptance Test at the Spacecraft Vendor Facility Support (Remaining FMs)

- Delivery and Launch Dates

| Flight Model | Delivery Date | Launch Date     |
|--------------|---------------|-----------------|
| FM1          | July 1, 2032  | October 1, 2034 |
| FM2          | July 1, 2033  | October 1, 2037 |
| FM3          | July 1, 2034  | October 1, 2040 |

- Funding Profile

| Government FY27 | GFY28 | GFY29 |
|-----------------|-------|-------|
| 10%             | 20%   | 20%   |

- Percentages calculated against the total proposed cost/price.



- Less prescriptive instructions
  - Content requested is similar
  - Page limit remains 105 pages
- Subfactor points have changed to better align with SMBA priorities
  - Technical performance
  - Reliance on non-Government processes

| Subfactor                                      | Points |
|------------------------------------------------|--------|
| Subfactor A – Technical Approach               | 500    |
| Subfactor B – Management Approach              | 400    |
| Subfactor C – Small Business Utilization (SBU) | 100    |
| Total                                          | 1000   |



- Revolutionary Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) Overhaul
- Requirements Documents Updates
- Time of Delivery Incentive
  - \$2M for successful Pre-Ship Review completion as determined by the Government on or before the Delivery Date
- Acceptance Events and Transition to Time and Material Task Order Mechanism
  - Acceptance will occur at the following events:
    - FM1 – Post-Commissioning or Launch + 6 months
    - Remaining FMs: Post-Bench Acceptance Test at the Spacecraft Vendor Facility
  - The transition to the Time and Material Task Order mechanism will occur at the same point as the Acceptance Events
- Government Furnished Property
  - Information on calibration reference target available from Contracting Officer upon request
- Past Performance
  - Prime Offeror size relevancy is now \$90M

# SMBA PRD NS1-SMBA-REQ-0001 Rev E

## Change Overview

- Updates to the SMBA PRD are in response to:
  - Industry partner responses to:
    - Draft RFP Amendment 19 posted 1/20/2026 (Industry Day for PRD Change Summary)
  - Internal NASA technical discussions
  - NASA program and project changes
- Changes from SMBA PRD Rev D to Rev E affect Sections 4 & 6
  - Major performance, function, and test requirement revisions are on the next slides
  - Requirements are renumbered in sequential order
  - Editorial changes throughout

# SMBA PRD Performance Requirements Change Summary

| PRD Sect.    | PRD Rev E Req ID | Description of change                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|--------------|------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 4.1          | Table 4.1-1      | <b>Extended the J-band range up to 238 GHz</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Additional protected spectrum added above 229 GHz channel</li> <li>• Aligns with Table 6.2-2 RS to In-band transmitters which requires analysis up to 238 GHz</li> </ul>                                                                                                   |
| 4.1          | Table 4.1-2      | <b>Changes to Hyperspectral Resolution column</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Relaxed the V-band narrowest hyperspectral resolution (<math>\leq 1\text{MHz}</math>) requirement to be around the two heritage channel absorption peaks with an objective to extend the narrow resolution to additional absorption peaks as design permits.</li> </ul> |
| 4.1<br>4.8.1 | Table 4.1-3      | <b>Removed the linear polarization direction for heritage channels</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Removed polarization column in Table 4.1-3 and deleted Rev D SMBA-35</li> <li>• Other polarization requirements are unchanged</li> </ul>                                                                                                           |

# SMBA PRD Performance Requirements Change Summary

| PRD Sect. | PRD Rev E Req ID                                | Description of change                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|-----------|-------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 4.4       | Table 4.1-3<br>Table 4.1-4<br>SMBA-3<br>SMBA-25 | <b>Modified radiometric sensitivity requirements</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Added NEDT requirement for heritage channels (SMBA-3, Table 4.1-3 &amp; notes, Section 4.4 text)</li> <li>• Adjusted Thermal Noise Contribution to NEDT values (Table 4.1-4 &amp; notes).</li> <li>• See Q&amp;A for example calculation</li> </ul> |
| 4.7       | Text<br>Equation 6                              | <b>Clarified 1/f noise ratio</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Updated text</li> <li>• Added Equation 6</li> <li>• See Q&amp;A for example calculation</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                      |
| 4.9       | SMBA-51<br>SMBA-52                              | <b>Relaxed SRF requirements to align with test equipment capabilities</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |

# SMBA PRD Functional and Test Requirements Change Summary

| PRD Sect. | PRD Rev E Req ID                                               | Description of change                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|-----------|----------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 6.2       | Table 6.2-1<br>Table 6.2-2<br>SMBA-188<br>SMBA-189<br>SMBA-190 | <b>Updated Radiated Susceptibility to External transmitters</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Updated to address instrument component survival at the Launch Site and instrument operate-through exposures from external transmitters while at the Launch Site &amp; On-Orbit.</li><li>• Launch Site includes Factory, Transport, PPF, Launch Vehicle, and Ascent.</li><li>• Reduced upper end of spectrum to be tested and/or analyzed from 325 GHz down to 238 GHz to align with Table 4.1-1.</li><li>• Changed several instances of TBS to TBD for Table 6.2-2 for spectrum where the instrument may be sensitive in unprotected spectrum and may be exposed to external transmitters.</li><li>• Updated references to Table 6.2-1 in SMBA-213 and SMBA-214</li></ul> |

- Industry Day – March 18, 2026
  - On amendments 23-25 and other recent updates
- One on Ones – Requested during week of March 23, 2026
  - Ongoing until RFP release
- RFP Release – End of Q1 CY 2026 or Beginning of Q2 CY2026
- Proposals Due – 60 calendar days later
- Award – Q3 CY 2027

Discussion Continues to be Welcome Until Blackout at RFP Release!



# Questions?

The background of the slide features a stylized world map. The map is composed of a network of blue dots connected by thin, light blue lines, creating a mesh-like structure. The dots are more densely packed in some areas, particularly over the continents, and less dense in others, like the oceans. The overall color scheme is a gradient of dark blue, with the map elements appearing in lighter shades of blue and white. The word "Questions?" is written in a large, white, sans-serif font on the left side of the image.